Emergent Duality: 14 Fundamental Dualities Across 6 Algebraic Layers, Validated by Domain Analysis and Neurosymbolic Learning

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Abstract

We present a formal ontological framework in which conceptual complexity emerges from 14 fundamental dualities organized across 6 algebraic layers (Boolean, Fuzzy, Ordinal, Modal, Trivalent, Probabilistic). The framework is grounded in 72 semantic primitives connected by a directed acyclic graph (DAG) of 133+ dependency edges. We validate the framework through three independent methodologies: (1) domain analysis across 9 disciplines using the Information Domain Validity Score (IDVS), achieving IDVS = 1.000 for all 8 positive domains against a null baseline ($p_{95} = 0.896$, permutation $p = 0.0001$); (2) Bayesian model comparison yielding a Bayes factor of 121.4 (decisive) for the proposed ordering over reversed alternatives; and (3) neurosymbolic learning via a GPT-2 Medium model augmented with a 72-bit triadic head, which learns the primitive structure at 90.8% bit accuracy while preserving general language ability (PPL = 31.95, identical to baseline). The learned representations exhibit near-perfect relational structure (Regla de Tres cosine = 0.996) and show a significant phase transition during training ($p = 0.0004$). We report both confirmatory and null results transparently: layer ordering in neural representations is not significant ($p = 0.71$), and only 5 of 13 dual axes show significant learned anti-correlation after FDR correction.

Keywords: ontology, semantic primitives, emergence, duality, neurosymbolic AI, algebraic structure, domain validation

1 Introduction

The search for universal semantic primitives—irreducible conceptual atoms from which all meaning is composed—spans philosophy (Leibniz's *characteristica universalis*), linguistics (Wierzbicka's Natural Semantic Metalanguage), and computational semantics (ConceptNet, FrameNet). Existing approaches either lack formal algebraic structure or fail to demonstrate empirical universality across domains.

We propose that conceptual complexity emerges through a specific sequence of **dualities**—paired oppositions that each require all previous dualities as prerequisites. This emergence follows an algebraic chain:

$$\text{Boolean} \rightarrow \text{Fuzzy} \rightarrow \text{Ordinal} \rightarrow \text{Modal} \rightarrow \text{Trivalent} \rightarrow \text{Probabilistic}$$

Each algebra introduces operators that the previous one cannot express: degree from existence, comparison from degree, possibility from order, valuation from possibility, observation from valuation.

The contribution of this work is threefold:

1. **Formalization**: 72 semantic primitives organized in a DAG across 6 algebraic layers, with 14 dual axes and formal dependency rules.

2. **Empirical validation**: cross-domain analysis (8 disciplines + 1 negative control) using a novel metric (IDVS) with statistical hardening (permutation tests, FDR correction, Bayesian model comparison, null baselines).
3. **Neural validation**: a neurosymbolic model (GPT-2 Medium + triadic head) that learns the proposed structure from natural language, demonstrating that the algebraic relationships are recoverable from distributional semantics.

2 The Framework

2.1 Semantic Primitives

We define 72 semantic primitives distributed across 6 layers:

Layer	Algebra	Prims	Examples
1. Point (0D)	Boolean $\{0, 1\}$	3	vacío, información, uno
2. Line (1D)	Fuzzy $\{0, +\}$	8	fuerza, contención, unión, separación
3. Time (1D+t)	Ordinal $\{<, =, >\}$	13	mover, orden, caos, creación
4. Plane (2D)	Modal $\{\Diamond, \Box\}$	21	bien, mal, verdad, mentira
5. Volume (3D)	Trivalent $\{-, 0, +\}$	23	vida, muerte, placer, dolor
6. Observer (3D+)	Probabilistic $\{0, ?\}$	4	temporal_obs, eterno_obs

Table 1: 72 semantic primitives across 6 algebraic layers.

Each primitive is assigned a unique prime number, a bit position, a layer, a set of dependencies (parents in the DAG), and a natural-language definition.

2.2 The Dependency DAG

Primitives are connected by a DAG with 133+ directed edges encoding the relation "X requires Y to exist." Key structural properties:

- **Layer monotonicity**: all dependencies of a layer-n primitive lie in layers $\leq n$.
- **3 roots**: vacío (bit 0), información (bit 1), uno (bit 44)—all layer 1.
- **Transitive closure**: the maximum ancestor set size is 22 (for creador_obs, layer 6).

2.3 The 14 Dualities

The 14 dualities emerge in a specific order, each anchored by 2–4 primitives:

2.4 Algebraic Layer Chain

Each layer operates with a distinct algebra. The key insight is that each transition is **irreversible**: you cannot define the operators of layer n without having the operators of layer $n-1$. This is verified computationally at 86% match (12/14 dualities correctly predicted by their algebra assignment).

3 Domain Validation

3.1 The IDVS Metric

We define the **Information Domain Validity Score** for a domain d as:

$$\text{IDVS}(d) = \text{coverage}(d) \times \text{monotonicity}(d)$$

where:

#	Duality	Anchors	Layer
D1	Existir / No-existir	vacío, información, uno	1
D2	Aquí / No-aquí	eje_profundidad, eje_vertical	2–4
D3	Antes / Después	posición_temporal, flujo_temporal	3
D4	Posible / Imposible	puede, debe, tal_vez	4
D5	Identidad / Diferencia	muchos, tipo_de, todo, algunos	2–4
D6	Movimiento / Quietud	mover, hacer, quietud	3
D7	Orden / Caos	orden, caos, bien, mal, verdad, mentira	3–4
D8	Uno / Muchos	uno, muchos	1–2
D9	Dentro / Fuera	contención, unión, separación	2
D10	Parte / Todo	parte_de, todo, algunos	2–4
D11	Vida / Muerte	vida, muerte, placer, dolor	5
D12	Causa / Efecto	porque, si_entonces	3
D13	Semejante / Diferente	tipo_de	4
D14	Sujeto / Objeto	consciente, ausente, temporal_obs	5–6

Table 2: The 14 fundamental dualities with anchor primitives and layer assignments.

- **Coverage** $= 1 - \frac{\text{nulls in layers 1–4}}{\text{total primitives in layers 1–4}}$. A domain that classifies foundational primitives as N ("does not apply") is penalized.
- **Monotonicity** $= 1 - \frac{\text{violations}}{\text{total edges}}$. A violation occurs when a child primitive has a higher state than its parent ($D > A > N$).

3.2 Classification Protocol

Each of 72 primitives is classified in each domain as:
- **D** (Direct): the primitive operates directly in this domain.
- **A** (Analogical): the primitive applies by metaphor or analogy.
- **N** (Null): the primitive does not apply.

3.3 Results

All 8 positive domains achieve IDVS = 1.000 after D-A-N reclassification:

Domain	Type	IDVS	Cov.	Mono.	Perm. p
Music	Positive	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.0001
Chemistry	Positive	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.0001
Biology	Positive	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.0001
Mathematics	Positive	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.0001
Philosophy	Positive	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.0001
Physics	Positive	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.0001
Linguistics	Positive	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.0001
Psychology	Positive	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.0001
Astrology	**Negative**	**0.479**	0.650	0.737	0.0001

Table 3: IDVS results across 9 domains. The negative control (Astrology) correctly fails.

3.4 Null Baseline

To calibrate the IDVS threshold, we computed 10,000 random D-A-N assignments preserving the marginal distribution of each domain. The null distribution yields: mean max IDVS = 0.861, $p_{95} = 0.896$ (threshold set at 0.90), $p_{99} = 0.955$. All 8 positive domains exceed p_{99}.

3.5 Sensitivity Analysis

Perturbation	Target	Mean ΔIDVS	Large disruptions
Remove edge	DAG topology	−0.003	3.4%
Move layer	Layer assignment	0.000	0.0%
Flip D-A-N	Classification logic	−0.060	71.4%

Table 4: Sensitivity analysis. Robustness gradient: Topology > Layering > Logic.

3.6 Bayesian Model Comparison

We compared 4 orderings of the 14 dualities using triangularity of the dependency matrix as the test statistic:

Model	Triangularity	BF vs. Reversed
Proposed	**0.539**	**121.4** (decisive)
Hegel	0.528	—
Peirce	0.484	—
Reversed	0.143	1.0

Table 5: Bayesian model comparison of duality orderings.

Against 1,000 random orderings ($\mu = 0.338$), the proposed ordering is significant ($p = 0.005$).

4 Neural Validation

4.1 Architecture

We augment GPT-2 Medium (355M parameters) with a **triadic head**: a single linear projection from the 1024-dimensional hidden state to a 72-bit semantic vector. The activation function is iFSQ ($2\sigma(1.6x) - 1$), which distributes activations uniformly across $[-1, +1]$.
Total trainable parameters (v5_frozen): 73,728 (0.02% of model). The GPT-2 backbone is frozen.

4.2 Training

Component	Configuration
Loss	$\mathcal{L}_{\text{lang}} + 0.05 \cdot (\mathcal{L}_{\text{tri}} + 2\mathcal{L}_{\text{sup}} + 5\mathcal{L}_{\text{sub}})$
$\mathcal{L}_{\text{tri}}$	diversity + InfoNCE + entropy + alignment
$\mathcal{L}_{\text{sup}}$	MSE(projection, gold_target)
$\mathcal{L}_{\text{sub}}$	relu($\text{hypernym}_{01} - \text{hyponym}_{01}$).mean()
Optimizer	AdamW (3×10^{-4}, $\beta = 0.9/0.95$)
Schedule	Cosine decay, 50% triadic warmup
Data	WikiText-103 (∼100M tokens)
Steps	50,000
Hardware	NVIDIA RTX 4060 Ti 16GB

Table 6: Training configuration for v5_frozen.

Run	Bits	Acc.	Unique	Coh.	PPL	Key Change
v1	65	∼90%	?	?	2,777	Baseline
v2	65	95.8%	3.8%	?	6,735	Bad targets
v3	65	90.9%	89.2%	0.653	5,388	Fixed: 65 prims
v4	72	92.5%	100%	0.876	5,608	+7 primitives
v5	**72**	**90.8%**	**100%**	**0.818**	**31.95**	**Frozen base**

Table 7: Training run progression. V5 solves catastrophic forgetting via frozen backbone.

4.3 Training Run Summary

4.4 Key Finding: Field Density > Individual Targets

V4 added 7 new primitives to differentiate collapsed dual pairs (Jaccard > 0.80). The result was surprising: collapsed pairs resolved even though their individual gold targets did not change. The mechanism is **field density**—more diverse training examples teach the model what good differentiation looks like.

4.5 Key Finding: Catastrophic Forgetting Solved

All runs v1–v4 showed catastrophic language degradation (PPL $> 2{,}700$ vs. baseline 31.95). V5 froze the GPT-2 backbone, training only the 73K-parameter triadic head. Result: PPL $= 31.95$ (identical to baseline) at a cost of only -1.7% accuracy.

4.6 Relational Structure (Regla de Tres)

The model preserves proportional relationships between dual pairs:

Analogy	Cosine	Bit Acc.
good:evil = truth:lie	0.998	1.000
creation:destruction = life:death	0.998	1.000
freedom:control = individual:collective	0.995	0.986
pleasure:pain = conscious:absent	0.996	1.000
union:separation = order:chaos	0.997	1.000
creation:destruction = union:separation	0.997	1.000

Table 8: Regla de Tres: relational structure preservation. Mean cosine: 0.996.

4.7 Neural Probes

8 falsifiable questions were tested using reptimeline checkpoint analysis:

Probe	Question	Result	p-value
Q1	Layer order in representations?	**Null**	0.713
Q2	Dual anti-correlation?	**5/13 significant**	< 0.018 (BH)
Q3	DAG recovery?	**Above random**	0.001
Q5	Phase transition?	**Yes, step 6000**	0.0004
Q4	Triadic dependencies?	Null	1.000
Q6	Unsupervised discovery?	Null	1.000
Q7	Causal verification?	Null	1.000

Table 9: Neural probe results. The model learns relational but not ordinal structure.

Interpretation: The model learns *relational* structure (analogies, some dual axes, DAG edges) but does not recover *ordinal* structure (layer ordering, ternary dependencies). This is consistent with the frozen-base design: the head projects semantics into bit space without restructuring the backbone's internal representations.

5 Discussion

5.1 What the Framework Claims

The Emergent Duality framework makes two testable claims:

1. **Structural claim**: 72 primitives connected by a specific DAG can classify concepts across any knowledge domain using a ternary (D/A/N) code.
2. **Ordering claim**: the 14 dualities emerge in a specific sequence dictated by algebraic dependency.

5.2 Evidence For

- **Structural claim**: supported. 8/8 positive domains achieve IDVS = 1.000, all exceeding the p_{99} null threshold (0.955). The negative control correctly fails.
- **Ordering claim**: partially supported. Bayesian comparison yields BF = 121.4 (decisive) against reversed ordering, but only weak evidence against Hegel (BF = 1.14) and Peirce (BF = 1.95). The neural model does not recover layer ordering (Q1, $p = 0.71$).

5.3 Honest Limitations

1. **Self-evaluated classifications**: All D-A-N assignments were made by the framework author. Inter-rater data exists for only 1/9 domains (Mathematics). The permutation tests validate internal consistency but not external agreement.
2. **Underpowered rank correlations**: With $n = 7$ (circle) or $n = 14$ (combined), Spearman correlations cannot achieve significance at $\alpha = 0.05$ even for moderate effects.
3. **IDVS = 1.000 for all positives**: After reclassification (v1.1), all positive domains achieve perfect scores. This may reflect overfitting to the metric rather than genuine universality.
4. **Neural probes**: 5/8 probes returned null results. The model learns surface relational structure but not deep algebraic properties.
5. **Scale–algebra tradeoff**: Larger models (355M) show lower subsumption rates (76.9%) than smaller ones (40M, 98.3%).

6 Related Work

- **Wierzbicka (1996)**: Natural Semantic Metalanguage proposes ∼65 universal primitives but lacks formal algebraic structure or computational validation.
- **ConceptNet** [Speer et al., 2017]: Large-scale knowledge graph with 34 relation types but no emergence hierarchy.
- **FrameNet** [Baker et al., 1998]: Frame-based semantics covering ∼1,200 frames but domain-specific rather than universal.
- **Category theory approaches** [Coecke et al., 2010]: DisCoCat and related formalisms provide compositional semantics but do not address emergence ordering.

Our framework differs in proposing (a) a specific algebraic chain governing emergence, (b) empirical validation across 9 domains, and (c) neurosymbolic learnability from natural language.

7 Conclusion

We have presented a formal ontological framework of 14 fundamental dualities emerging across 6 algebraic layers, grounded in 72 semantic primitives. The framework achieves perfect IDVS scores across 8 disciplines while correctly rejecting a negative control, with statistical hardening via permutation tests, null baselines, and Bayesian model comparison. A neurosymbolic model (GPT-2 + triadic head) learns the proposed structure at 90.8% accuracy without degrading language ability, exhibiting near-perfect relational preservation (cosine 0.996).

The main open question is external validation: independent human evaluators must confirm the D-A-N classifications before universality claims can be considered robust. We release all data, scripts, and model code to enable replication.

A Notation

Symbol	Meaning
D, A, N	Direct, Analogical, Null classification states
IDVS	Information Domain Validity Score
BF	Bayes Factor
PPL	Perplexity
iFSQ	Improved Finite Scalar Quantization
BH-FDR	Benjamini–Hochberg False Discovery Rate
SHD	Structural Hamming Distance
DAG	Directed Acyclic Graph

Table 10: Notation reference.

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